

TOMMY LAI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full-stack developer with 4+ years of professional experience: enterprise Java / Spring systems in regulated financial services, plus modern web and e-commerce delivery (React/Next.js, Shopify, WordPress) for Canadian small-business clients. Strong REST API design and SQL; daily user of AI-assisted development tools (Claude Code, GitHub Copilot) to accelerate build, refactor, and debug cycles. Fluent in English, Mandarin, and Cantonese.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Back-End: Java, Spring Boot, Spring MVC, Hibernate, RESTful APIs, Python, Django, Node.js

Front-End: React, Next.js, JavaScript / TypeScript, HTML5, CSS3/SCSS, responsive & accessible UI (WCAG)

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Oracle — complex queries, query optimisation, ORM

E-Commerce / CMS: Shopify (live storefront, Liquid), WordPress / WooCommerce, Elementor, Wix, Drupal 11 (DDEV, Views, Twig)

Cloud & Infra: Docker, AWS (SES), Vercel, DNS management, CI/CD, Git/GitHub

AI-Assisted Development: Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor — integrated into daily development workflow

Marketing & Analytics: Google Ads, Facebook Ads, SEO (structured metadata, page-speed optimisation), Excel data analysis

Methodology: Agile/Scrum, JIRA, OOP, Clean Architecture, technical documentation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance Web Developer (Full-Stack) | Self-Employed, Toronto, ON

Mar 2022 – Present

React/Next.js · Shopify · WordPress/WooCommerce · SEO · Client Management

- Design, build, and maintain production websites and e-commerce storefronts for Toronto small-business clients; own the full lifecycle from requirements and scoping to DNS/hosting and post-launch support.
- Rainbow Hair Salon (React/Next.js on Vercel): responsive client site with Google Maps integration, performance-optimised animations, and structured metadata for search discoverability.
- Yum Tong'La (Shopify + parallel WordPress/WooCommerce build): live storefront with end-to-end catalogue management and bilingual content; wrote a plain-language admin guide enabling the non-technical owner to self-manage.
- Isotope Construction (isotopeconstruction.com): responsive company site; cut page load times by 40% through performance tuning and image optimisation.
- Serve clients in English, Cantonese, and Mandarin — covering Toronto's multilingual small-business market.

Baking Specialist | Terroni Inc., Toronto, ON

Jul 2022 – Present

- High-volume production role held in parallel with freelance development practice; maintained 100% quality consistency across 500+ daily units and improved production efficiency by 15% through process analysis and team coordination.

Senior Programmer (Full-Stack) | Hong Kong Life Insurance Limited, Hong Kong

Oct 2020 – May 2022

Java · Spring MVC · Hibernate · PostgreSQL · SAP Crystal Reports · Agile

- Maintained and enhanced mission-critical insurance systems handling 100+ daily transactions at 99% uptime in a regulated financial environment.
- Resolved 100+ UAT and production defects through systematic root-cause analysis, reducing downtime by 25%; produced thorough technical documentation for long-term maintainability.
- Built 10+ statistical reports delivering data-driven insights to 50+ stakeholders; managed requirements traceability from design through delivery.

- Led system integration testing and worked directly with non-technical business stakeholders under strict change-control processes.

Associate Consultant | Computer and Technologies Solutions Limited, Hong Kong

Sep 2018 – Jul 2020

Java · Struts2 · Hibernate · MySQL · RESTful APIs · Agile

- Developed a full Museum Collection Management System from scratch using OOP and MVC principles, streamlining workflows for 20+ end users across multiple sites.
- Optimised database query strategies on a high-volume dataset, improving data access speeds by 30%.
- Identified and resolved 100+ software defects through close stakeholder collaboration, achieving high user adoption at deployment.

ADDITIONAL PROJECTS

Price Compare App | Python · Django · RESTful APIs · PostgreSQL · Vercel

Jun 2024 – Present

pricecompareapp.vercel.app

- Architected and deployed a full-stack REST API application with Django back-end and responsive front-end, demonstrating cloud deployment and API integration.

Drupal 11 Practice Build | Drupal 11 · DDEV · Twig · SCSS · Accessibility

2026

github.com/tommylai0902/drupal-practice

- Local DDEV environment with custom content types, Views, a custom sub-theme with Twig templates, SCSS pipeline, and WCAG accessibility features.

2D Unity Platformer (in development) | Unity · C# · AI-assisted workflow

2025 – Present

- Character movement, combat, checkpoint, and enemy-AI systems built on a composition pattern; developed using Claude Code as a core part of the workflow.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **BSc Computer Engineering** — Hong Kong Metropolitan University, 2016 – 2018
- Google UX Design Foundations — Coursera, Jun 2026 (Credential ID LXD3H0F1A03I)
- Python for Everybody Specialization — University of Michigan / Coursera, May 2026
- Create Your E-Commerce Store with Shopify — Coursera, May 2026 (Grade: 100%)

LANGUAGES

English (Fluent) · Mandarin (Native) · Cantonese (Native)